



Goodbye Windows Phone

Microsoft will end support for its Windows 10 Mobile smartphone OS on December 10 2019. <https://digit.in/feb19-17>



Toyota, Panasonic collab

Toyota Motors and Panasonic to set up a joint-venture company for solid-state battery manufacturing for BEVs. <https://digit.in/feb19-18>

Xiaomi Mi LED TV 55-inch 4X Pro

A 55-inch 4K HDR TV for the budget consumer

When Xiaomi brought TVs to India, their first offering was a flagship 55-inch TV that was a mere 4.9mm slim, had an all-glass front and impressed us with its PatchWall UI. Xiaomi has launched the Mi TV 4X Pro, 55-inch 4K HDR TV at Rs 39,999. Does it do enough to disrupt the market?

Build and design

The TV isn't as slim as the other 55-inch offering from Xiaomi. The TV has a plastic shell. The borders of the TV surrounding the display are plastic with a brushed aluminium look. The two plastic feet for tabletop mounting hold the TV firmly in place. The tabletop stand has a curved design. In a tabletop setup, there is about 3.5-inches of space below the TV. Note that there's no 3.5mm connectivity for speakers, with S/PDIF as the only option for audio output. Overall, the build of the TV is sturdy, but not as premium as the Mi TV 4.

Display and picture quality

Just like the Mi TV 4, the Mi TV 4X Pro boasts of a 10-bit panel, 4K capabilities along with HDR. The Mi TV 4X Pro is available in VA and IPS panel options. There is no way for you to choose one when you purchase it.

4K and HDR playback

When it comes to 4K videos, the TV's performance is as good as its predecessor if not better. This time around content looks sharp and sequences in brightly lit scenes look vivid. With dynamic backlighting on content looks dimmer. Considering the price of the TV, its performance is good.

The TV panel is noticeably reflective, and that is the case even with our IPS panel variant. It has good viewing angles, however, after a point, about 150 degrees, you will start to notice a slight colour shift.



1080p content

1080p content looks good if you have a good source. If you will consume content from a Fire TV stick on this TV, then your experience will be good overall. There isn't any visible native upscaling per se on the TV, and the experience is enjoyable. The colours are good too.

Gaming

The TV has a Game preset, which should help with input lag. The games in 4K SDR and HDR look really good. Some games, especially the ones in HDR give you the option to toggle the game's brightness to optimise its visual performance. We highly recommend you do that as it will make a difference in your experience.

Audio

The audio from the two 10W speakers is loud and good enough for everyday TV viewing. But for movies and gaming, it is quite underwhelming. It's safe to say, that you will need a pair of speakers to enjoy movies on this TV as we experienced audio falling short.

UI and remote control

The UI on the Mi 4X Pro aggregates content from service providers and



FEATURES.....	74
PERFORMANCE.....	75
BUILD	74
VALUE FOR MONEY....	69

presents them to you in an orderly manner. There is also a special section for regional content which is nice. You can also integrate your set-top box content.

The remote control has few buttons and the only one that is missed is the mute button. Due to

Bluetooth connectivity, you don't need to point it directly to the TV to use it. It also has voice controls bringing up the Google Assistant on the TV.

Verdict

The Mi TV 4X Pro has a simple, and slightly dumbed down design. But what you lose in build quality, the TV makes up for with a smooth UI, good picture performance and an easy-to-use remote control. Where it falls short is with its audio performance along with the lack of native support for Netflix and Prime Video. However, for a budget of ₹40k this TV is definitely a value for money proposition.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 55-inch | PANEL TYPE: IPS/VA | PANEL RESOLUTION: 3840 x 2160 - 4K | REFRESH RATE: 60Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: Yes | RAM: 2GB | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 8GB

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